

Week 28: Hell

BIG IDEA

Hell is not God; it is the tragic consequence of rejecting God. God does not send anyone there; we send ourselves by choosing not to want him. God invites us into relationship but never forces us, and that is love in action. Be patient as students process this hard reality.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Rob Bell's Love Wins stirred controversy by suggesting endless chances to get to God and that hell is not really accurate, and students gravitated toward it.
- The Bible is clear and Jesus is really clear that hell exists, but students discount it because no one wants to face consequences.
- The intro experience has students imagine their favorite place, then strip out all its goodness, value, and joy, to sense what hell would be like.
- Another picture: common grace is God sustaining every breath, sun, and rain for everyone; hell is all of that removed, uninhabitable.
- God does not send anyone to hell; we send ourselves by choosing not to want him, and God honors that choice.
- Students will ask how a good God who allows evil can also have hell; invite open discussion rather than Bible-thumping, and let them process patiently.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Describe your favorite place, then remove everything good about it. What would be left, and what does that suggest hell is like?
2. If God is good and loving, why would hell exist as a consequence? Is that a contradiction?
3. Does God send people to hell, or do we send ourselves? What difference does that make?
4. How is God refusing to force us into relationship with him actually love in action?

Summary of the Week 28 Leader Video for this church's Awana® leaders — internal ministry use only. Awana® and Journey: Advocates® are trademarks of Awana Clubs International. This summary is not affiliated with or endorsed by Awana; content follows the Leader Video's transcript ([public/transcripts/week-28-leader.vtt](https://public.transcripts/week-28-leader.vtt)).